ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

GRADE 8

ENGLISH FIRST ADDITIONAL LANGUAGE

PAPER 1 · PRACTICE B

MARKS: 70 **TIME: 2 hours**

Language in context. Section A: Comprehension – a magazine article and a table (25) · Section B: Summary (10) · Section C: Language in context – advertisement, cartoon and language structures (35). All texts were written by Academic Central.

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the CAPS curriculum for Grade 8. It is not a Department of Basic Education examination paper.

INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. This question paper consists of THREE sections: SECTION A: Comprehension (25 marks), SECTION B: Summary (10 marks) and SECTION C: Language in context (35 marks).
2. Answer ALL the questions.
3. Read ALL the texts carefully before you answer the questions.
4. Number your answers exactly as the questions are numbered.
5. Answer in full sentences unless you are told otherwise. Use your own words where you are asked to.
6. Spend about 50 minutes on Section A, 20 minutes on Section B and 50 minutes on Section C.

SECTION A: COMPREHENSION

QUESTION 1

Read TEXT A and TEXT B and answer the questions that follow.

TEXT A: The Seed Keepers of Ngqeleni

1 In the hills near Ngqeleni in the Eastern Cape, thirteen-year-old Lwazi Mbeki keeps a library. It has no books. Instead, its shelves are lined with glass jars, old peanut-butter tubs and paper envelopes, each one carefully labelled in his neat handwriting: *amaranth (imifino)*, *cowpeas*, *pumpkin – grey*, *sorghum – red*.

2 "It is a seed library," Lwazi explains, holding up a jar of speckled beans. "You borrow seeds in spring. You plant them, you eat, and at the end of the season you bring back more seeds than you took."

3 The idea began in his grandmother's kitchen. Every winter, Gogo MaDlamini dried seeds from her best plants and stored them in tins above the stove. "Bought seed is expensive," she told him, "and some of it does not grow again next year. These seeds know our soil. They have been in this family longer than I have." When a neighbour asked for some of her pumpkin seeds, Lwazi had an idea: what if the whole village could share?

4 His first attempt was a disaster. He lent out forty packets and only seven came back. "People forgot, or they ate everything," he says, laughing now. "I was very angry." Instead of giving up, he changed the rules. Borrowers now sign a register, and the library holds a seed-swapping day every April, with music and food, so that returning seeds feels like a celebration rather than a chore.

5 The changes worked. In the second year, almost every borrower brought seeds back. Teachers at Lwazi's school noticed, and the library moved into an empty storeroom next to the school garden. Learners now help to sort and label the seeds in the afternoons, and the agriculture teacher uses the library to teach about plant reproduction.

6 There is a bigger reason why projects like this matter. Many traditional crops, such as sorghum and certain kinds of beans, can survive dry spells better than some modern varieties. As droughts

become more common, these old seeds may help families to keep growing food. "My grandmother calls them our insurance," Lwazi says. "If the rain fails, these seeds still try."

7 Lwazi's dream is to see a seed library in every village in the district. He has already written a simple guide, with drawings, explaining how to start one. "You do not need money," he says. "You need jars, a register and people who keep their promises."

This article was written for this examination. Lwazi and his seed library are fictional.

TEXT B: Seed library records

Year	Packets lent	Packets returned	Borrowers
Year 1	40	7	25
Year 2	120	110	64
Year 3	260	251	130

1.1 In which province is Ngqeleni? (1)

1.2 What is unusual about Lwazi's library (paragraph 1)? (1)

1.3 Explain, in your own words, how the seed library works (paragraph 2). (2)

1.4 Give TWO reasons why Gogo MaDlamini kept her own seeds (paragraph 3). (2)

1.5 "These seeds know our soil." Identify the figure of speech and explain what Gogo means. (2)

1.6 Why does the writer call Lwazi's first attempt "a disaster" (paragraph 4)? (1)

1.7 Name TWO changes Lwazi made to solve the problem. (2)

1.8 What does Lwazi's response to his first failure show about his character? Give a reason. (2)

1.9 Find ONE word in paragraph 4 that means "a boring task that must be done". (1)

1.10 Give TWO ways in which the school uses the seed library (paragraph 5). (2)

1.11 Why can traditional seeds be called "insurance" (paragraph 6)? (2)

1.12 Choose the correct answer. Write only the letter. The word "district" in paragraph 7 means: A a kind of seed B an area or region C a school subject D a library rule (1)

1.13 Do you agree that "you do not need money" to start a seed library? Give a reason for your answer. (2)

1.14 Refer to TEXT B. How many packets were returned in Year 2? (1)

1.15 Refer to TEXT A and TEXT B. Calculate the percentage of packets returned in Year 1 and in Year 3. Does this support what is said in paragraph 5? Explain. (3)

[25]

SECTION B: SUMMARY

QUESTION 2

Read the text below. List SEVEN things a household can do to waste less food.

1. Write SEVEN points in full sentences, numbered 1 to 7.
2. Use your OWN words as far as possible.
3. Your summary must not be more than 80 words. Write the number of words you used at the end.

Waste Not, Want Not

Every year, millions of tonnes of food are thrown away in South Africa while many people go hungry. Families can help by changing a few habits. Before going shopping, check what is already in the cupboard and fridge, and write a shopping list so that you buy only what you need. Store food correctly: keep bread in a closed container and put fresh vegetables in the fridge. Cook the right amount of food for the number of people eating. Leftovers do not have to go to waste – they can be frozen or turned into a new meal the next day. Learn the difference between "best before" and "use by" dates, because food is often still safe after the "best before" date. Put older food at the front of the fridge so that it is eaten first. Finally, peels and other scraps that cannot be eaten can be added to a compost heap to feed the garden.

[10]

SECTION C: LANGUAGE IN CONTEXT

QUESTION 3: ADVERTISEMENT

Study the advertisement below and answer the questions.

BOUNCE INTO SUMMER!

JumpZone Trampoline Park – Kids jump FREE*

Over 40 trampolines · Foam pit · Dodgeball court · Birthday parties
Get fit while you have fun – exercise has never felt like this!

Book online at jumpzone.example – only 50 free tickets left!

*Free entry for ONE child under 6 with every two paying adults, Mondays only. Grip socks (R45) compulsory. Not valid on public holidays.

JumpZone is a made-up company, used only for this examination.

3.1 Who is the target audience of this advertisement? Give a reason. (2)

3.2 Quote the phrase that is meant to make readers act quickly, and explain why the advertiser uses it. (2)

3.3 Read the small print. Explain why "Kids jump FREE" is misleading. Give TWO reasons. (2)

3.4 "Bounce into summer!" Explain why this heading is effective. (1)

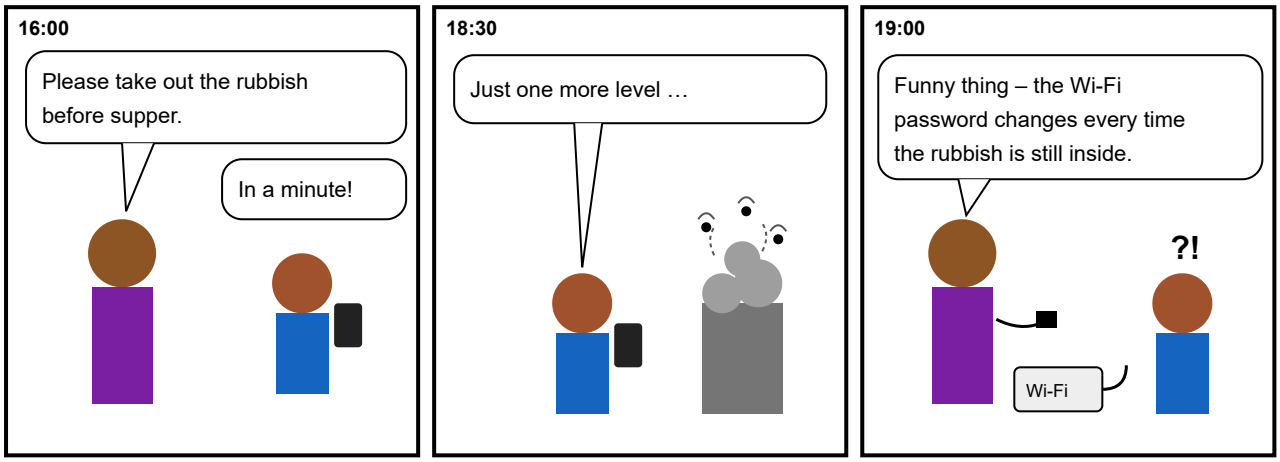
3.5 Identify the part of speech of "fit" in "Get fit while you have fun". (1)

3.6 Would you trust this advertisement? Give a reason for your answer. (2)

[10]

QUESTION 4: CARTOON

Study the cartoon below and answer the questions.



4.1 What does the mother ask the boy to do in frame 1? (1)

4.2 What is the boy doing instead of his chore in frame 2? Refer to the picture. (1)

4.3 What has the mother done in frame 3, and why? (2)

4.4 Explain why the mother's words in frame 3 are humorous. (2)

4.5 Rewrite the mother's words in frame 1 in reported (indirect) speech. Begin with: *The mother asked the boy …* (2)

[8]

QUESTION 5: LANGUAGE STRUCTURES AND CONVENTIONS

Read the paragraph below and answer the questions. The sentences are labelled (a) to (g).

(a) Our school choir sang beautifully at the regional festival. (b) The judges awarded the choir a gold medal. (c) "This is the best result in our school's history," said the conductor. (d) The learners, whose families had travelled far to watch, cheered loudly. (e) Unless we raise more money, the choir cannot go to the national finals. (f) The national finals will be more difficult than the regional festival. (g) Each of the singers have practised every day.

5.1 There is a concord error in sentence (g). Rewrite the sentence correctly. (1)

5.2 Rewrite sentence (b) in the passive voice. (2)

5.3 Rewrite sentence (c) in reported speech. Begin with: *The conductor said that …* (3)

5.4 Identify the adverb in sentence (a) and say what kind of adverb it is. (2)

5.5 Write down the relative pronoun in sentence (d). (1)

5.6 Rewrite sentence (e), starting with "If". (1)

5.7 Give the superlative degree of "difficult" in sentence (f). (1)

5.8 Give an antonym (opposite) for "loudly" in sentence (d). (1)

5.9 Rewrite sentence (a) in the future tense. (1)

5.10 The choir members were "on cloud nine" after the result. What does this idiom mean? (1)

5.11 Join these sentences using "because": *The learners were tired. They had sung for three hours.* (1)

5.12 Change sentence (a) into a question. (1)

5.13 Correct the spelling error in this sentence: *The choir recieved a certificate.* (1)

[17]

TOTAL SECTION C: [35]

TOTAL: 70

END OF QUESTION PAPER